Election Night

READ · Week 8, Tuesday · 11/3/26

Today is Election Day in Massachusetts. People vote for governor, for Congress, and for many other leaders. The polls close at 8 p.m. If you are a U.S. citizen, 18 or older, and registered, you can vote.

Ana became a citizen this year, so this is her first election. She is excited and a little nervous. In the morning, she checks her polling place online. “If I leave work at 5, I will vote before class,” she tells her friend Samir.

Samir is not a citizen yet, so he cannot vote. But leaders work for everyone in their city, not only voters. Last spring, the streetlight on Samir’s street broke. If a streetlight breaks, you contact the city. Samir called his city councilor’s office. They responded in two days, and the city fixed the light.

Different leaders have different jobs. If you have a problem on your street, you contact your city or town. If you have a question about a state law, you contact your state representative. If you have a question about a national law, you contact your members of Congress.

Tonight, Ana will watch the news after class. “If my candidate wins, I will celebrate with my family,” she says. “If my candidate loses, I will be sad. But I will vote again next time.” Some results come tonight. Others come in a few days. The winners start their new jobs in January.

polling place = where you go to vote · **registered** = your name is on the list of voters · **candidate** = a person who wants the job · **Congress** = leaders in Washington who make national laws

Part A: Understand

1. What time do the polls close today?

   _____

2. Why is this election special for Ana?

   _____

3. What will Ana do if she leaves work at 5?

   _____

4. Samir cannot vote. What did he do about the streetlight?

   _____

5. When do the winners start their new jobs?

   _____

Part B: Find the grammar

Zero = always true If + V1, V1	**First** = one real plan If + V1, will + V1

Underline 2 Zero sentences. **Circle** 2 First sentences.

Part C: Talk together

1. Who are some leaders in your city or town? What do they do?
2. What problem do you want a leader to fix? Who will you contact?
   “If ___ doesn’t get better, I will contact ___.”
3. Is Election Day different in your home country? How?
4. What will you do tonight after class? *“If I’m not tired, I will ___.”*

You can say “Pass.” *You never have to talk about your own voting or politics.*